# Zhuoyu (Rachel) Qiu

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## Research Interests

My research is in applied microeconomics, specializing labor economics and the economics of education. I use causal inference methods with large-scale administrative and survey data. My current work examines how family and educational environments shape human capital accumulation, child well-being, and gender disparities.

## Education

- **University of California, Riverside** — Riverside, CA, USA
  *Ph.D. in Economics* — *Sep. 2021 – Jun. 2027 (expected)*
- **Jinan University** — Guangzhou, China
  *M.S. in Economics, with Honors* — *Sep. 2019 – Jun. 2021*
- **Zhongnan University of Economics and Law** — Wuhan, China
  *B.S. in Economics, with Honors* — *Sep. 2014 – Jun. 2019*

## Job Market Paper

- **Gender Peer Effects and Women's Academic Performance in Mathematics: Evidence from a U.S. University [Link]**

**Abstract:** Understanding women's progress in mathematics can help explain their continued underrepresentation in mathematics-intensive fields. Using administrative records from a U.S. university, I exploit variation in female peer share across classes in a specific introductory mathematics course taught by a given instructor within an academic term. A 10-percentage-point (ppt) increase in female peer share raises women's mathematics completion probability by 3.1 ppt; on average, exposure to 10 more female classmates leads to about 1.4 additional completions among women. Women's benefits are concentrated among those entering with a STEM major, while both genders experience broader first-term academic gains. Longer-term results provide suggestive evidence of increased STEM degree attainment among women declaring a STEM major at entry.

## Publication

**[1] Punching Out, Not Down: The Impact of Paid Sick Leave on Child Maltreatment**. **Qiu, Z.** *Labour Economics, 2026*, 102958. [**Link**]

## Selected Work in Progress

- **Effects of Faculty Gender Attitudes on College Students' Short- and Long-Term Outcomes**

*With Radhika Bansal (University of California, Riverside), Ozkan Eren (University of California, Riverside), Krzysztof Karbownik (Emory University), and Ruinan Zhao (State of California Department of Industrial Relations)*

  - Link university records (2013–2024) with faculty Gender-Science Implicit Association Test responses to study student achievement, major choice, graduation, and earnings.
  - Preliminary findings associate stronger instructor gender bias with female students leaving their declared majors and a lower likelihood of on-time graduation.

- **The Impact of Marriage Tax Bonus and Penalty on Marital Decisions in the U.S.**

*With Zhe Yang (Liaoning University)*

  - Use SIPP data and an instrumental-variable strategy based on state and demographic variation to estimate how marriage tax incentives affect marriage formation and dissolution.
  - A 1% increase in the marriage-bonus-to-income ratio increases cohabiting couples' likelihood of marriage by 0.12%.

## Technical and Policy Reports

**[1] The State of Work in the Inland Empire Part II: Pandemic, Polarization, Inflation, and Investment**. Bates, M., Bruene, S., Calderon, E. E., De La Torre, E., Freire, P., Guo, J., Hutchins, G. B., Jackson, K., Kapoor, M., Nelson, F., **Qiu, Z.**, Reese, E., Rettberg, G., and Tamayose, B. C. *Inland Empire Labor and Community Center and Center for Social Innovation, University of California, Riverside, 2023*. [**Link**]

## Technical and Policy Reports (continued)

**[2] The State of Work: Transportation, Distribution, and Logistics in the Inland Empire**. Bainiwal, T. S., Bates, M., Brookes, M., Bruene, S., Calderon, E., Carranza, N., De La Torre, E., Freire, P., Gudis, C., Guo, J., Hutchins, G. B., Jackson, K., Kapoor, M., Nelson, F., **Qiu, Z.**, Reese, E., Rettberg, G., Tamayose, B., and Tan, A. *Inland Empire Labor and Community Center and Center for Social Innovation, University of California, Riverside, 2024*. [**Link**]

**[3] Thrive Inland SoCal: Labor Market Analysis**. Bates, M., Brookes, M., Bruene, S., Burnett, J., Calderon, E., Carbajal, A., De La Torre, E., Guo, J., Hutchins, G. B., Kapoor, M., Mukenge, K., Nelson, F., **Qiu, Z.**, Rana, S., Reese, E., Rettberg, G., Salam, I., and Tamayose, B. *Inland Empire Labor and Community Center and Center for Social Innovation, University of California, Riverside, 2024*. [**Link**]

## Teaching Experience

- **University of California, Riverside** — Riverside, CA, USA

*Instructor of Record (avg.: **4.78/5**)* — *Aug. 2025*

- Urban Economics *(Sum. 2025)*

*Teaching Assistant (avg.: **6.56/7** for sections w/ enroll. >10 & resp. rate > campus avg.)* — *Oct. 2022 – Present*

- Introductory Econometrics *(F. 2022; W. 2023; W. & F. 2024; W., Spr., & F. 2025; W. 2026)*
- Statistics for Economics *(F. 2023)*
- Intermediate Microeconomic Theory *(Spr. 2024; Spr. 2026)*

*Software Instructor* — *Jul. – Aug. 2023*

- Stata Boot Camp, Master of Public Policy Program

*Pedagogical Training* — *Jul. 2026*

- Summer Curriculum Design Institute

## Research Experience

- **Department of Economics, University of California, Riverside**
  *for Prof. Veronica Sovero, Graduate Student Researcher* — *Jul. – Sep. 2026*
- **Center for Social Innovation, University of California, Riverside**
  *Graduate Student Researcher* — *Apr. – Jun. 2023*
- **Peking University HSBC Business School**
  *for Prof. Yizhen Gu, Research Assistant* — *Dec. 2020 – Jun. 2021*
- **Guangzhou Academy of Social Sciences**
  *Research Assistant* — *Aug. – Dec. 2020*

## Presentations and Talks

- Economic Seminar Series, California State University Long Beach *(scheduled)* — *2026*
- Southern Economic Association (SEA) 96th Annual Meeting *(department nominated, scheduled)* — *2026*
- International Symposium on Contemporary Labor Economics, Xiamen University — *2025*
- Southern Economic Association (SEA) 95th Annual Meeting — *2025*
- Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Annual Fall Conference — *2025*
- 18th All-California Labor Economics Conference–Poster Session, Stanford University — *2025*
- China Economics Society (CES) China Annual Conference, Sun Yat-sen University — *2025*
- SEMi-Talk Academic Workshop, Tsinghua University — *2024*
- 15th All-California Labor Economics Conference–Poster Session, University of California, Riverside — *2022*

## Referee Service

- Journal of Labor Research

## Honors and Awards

- Dean's Distinguished Fellowship, University of California, Riverside — *2021 – Present*
- Outstanding Graduate Award, Jinan University — *2019 – 2021*

## Skills

**Software:** Stata, Python, MATLAB, R, SQL, LaTeX, Qualtrics

**Additional Skills:** Policy report writing, survey design, data visualization

**Language:** English (proficient), Mandarin (native), Cantonese (native), Hakka (fluent)

## References


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